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CHAPTER 1

ARRIVAL OF EUROPEANS IN INDIA (Part-4)

The French in India & Carnatic Wars

Introduction

The **French** were the **last Europeans** to come to India for trade. Like the Portuguese, Dutch, and English, they also established trading centres in India. Later, the French and the English fought a series of wars called the **Carnatic Wars**. These wars finally ended French political ambitions in India and made the English the strongest European power.

Arrival of the French

The French entered India mainly for trade.

Important Facts

- **French East India Company** was established in **1664**.
- It was founded during the reign of **King Louis XIV**.
- The company was established by **Jean-Baptiste Colbert**, the Finance Minister of France.

Exam Fact: 1664 → French East India Company established.

First French Factory

After forming the company, the French started trading in India.

Important Facts

- **1668** – First French factory established at **Surat**.
- It was established by **Francois Caron**.

Pondicherry

The French wanted a permanent base in India.

Important Facts

- **Pondicherry** was established in **1674**.
- **Francois Martin** developed Pondicherry into the main French settlement.
- Pondicherry became the **headquarters of the French in India**.

Exam Fact: Pondicherry = Headquarters of the French in India.

Decline of the French

The French could not become as powerful as the English.

Important Facts

- Continuous wars with the Dutch and the English weakened the French.
- In **1742**, **Joseph François Dupleix** became the French Governor.
- During his time, the **Carnatic Wars** began.
- The French were finally defeated by the English.

Carnatic Wars

The Carnatic Wars were fought between the **English** and the **French** in South India.

Why were these wars fought?

- Both countries wanted to control trade in India.
- Both wanted political power in South India.

First Carnatic War (1746–1748)

Important Facts

- Fought between **English** and **French**.
- Ended with the **Treaty of Aix-la-Chapelle (1748)**.

- The captured territories were returned to both sides.

Exam Fact: First Carnatic War → Treaty of Aix-la-Chapelle.

Second Carnatic War (1749–1754)

Important Facts

- Main leaders:
 - **Dupleix (French)**
 - **Robert Clive (English)**
- Ended with the **Treaty of Pondicherry (Treaty of Godeheu)**.
- French influence started declining.

Exam Fact: Robert Clive became famous during the Second Carnatic War.

Third Carnatic War (1758–1763)

This was the most important Carnatic War.

Important Facts

- Main battle: **Battle of Wandiwash (1760)**.
- English defeated the French.
- French army was led by **Count de Lally**.
- The war ended with the **Treaty of Paris (1763)**.
- The French were allowed to keep only a few trading centres.
- They were **not allowed to build forts or interfere in Indian politics**.

Exam Fact: Battle of Wandiwash (1760) ended French political power in India.

Result of the Carnatic Wars

The English became the strongest European power in India.

Important Facts

- French political power ended.
- English East India Company became supreme.
- French continued only limited trading activities.

Why did the French fail in India?

- Weak support from the French government.
- Lack of money and naval strength.
- Strong leadership of the English.
- British victory in the **Battle of Wandiwash**.

Important Personalities

Personality	Contribution
Louis XIV	King of France during the establishment of the French East India Company
Jean-Baptiste Colbert	Founder of the French East India Company
Francois Caron	Established first French factory at Surat
Francois Martin	Developed Pondicherry
Joseph François Dupleix	Famous French Governor; led French during Carnatic Wars
Robert Clive	English leader in the Second Carnatic War
Count de Lally	Commander of the French army in the Third Carnatic War

Important Places

Place	Importance
Surat	First French factory (1668)
Pondicherry	Headquarters of the French in India
Wandiwash (Tamil Nadu)	Decisive battle between English and French
Carnatic (South India)	Region where the Carnatic Wars were fought

Important Treaties & Battles

Name	Year	Importance
Treaty of Aix-la-Chapelle	1748	Ended First Carnatic War
Treaty of Pondicherry (Godeheu)	1754	Ended Second Carnatic War
Battle of Wandiwash	1760	English defeated the French
Treaty of Paris	1763	Ended Third Carnatic War

Important Years

Year	Event
1664	French East India Company established
1668	First French factory at Surat
1674	Pondicherry established
1742	Dupleix became Governor
1746–1748	First Carnatic War
1748	Treaty of Aix-la-Chapelle
1749–1754	Second Carnatic War
1754	Treaty of Pondicherry (Godeheu)
1758–1763	Third Carnatic War
1760	Battle of Wandiwash
1763	Treaty of Paris

Frequently Confused Facts

Question	Correct Answer
Last Europeans to come to India	French
French East India Company	1664
Founder of French East India Company	Jean-Baptiste Colbert
First French factory	Surat
Headquarters of the French	Pondicherry
French Governor	Dupleix
Battle that ended French power	Battle of Wandiwash

Commander of the French army	Count de Lally
Treaty ending First Carnatic War	Aix-la-Chapelle
Treaty ending Third Carnatic War	Paris (1763)

Previous Year Exam Focus

- French East India Company
- Pondicherry
- Dupleix
- Robert Clive
- Count de Lally
- Battle of Wandiwash
- Carnatic Wars
- Treaty of Paris
- Treaty of Aix-la-Chapelle

Expected MCQ Areas

- First French factory
- Pondicherry
- Dupleix
- Carnatic Wars
- Battle of Wandiwash
- Treaties
- Count de Lally
- Robert Clive

Quick Revision

- French Company → **1664**
- Colbert → **Founder**
- First Factory → **Surat**
- Pondicherry → **1674**
- Headquarters → **Pondicherry**
- Dupleix → **1742**
- First Carnatic War → **1746–48**

- Aix-la-Chapelle → **1748**
- Second Carnatic War → **1749–54**
- Robert Clive → **English**
- Third Carnatic War → **1758–63**
- Wandiwash → **1760**
- Count de Lally → **French Commander**
- Treaty of Paris → **1763**
- Winner → **English**
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